

HOUSE No. 1423**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Christine P. Barber and Michael P. Kushmerek*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to social work uplifting practices and exam removal.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Christine P. Barber</i>	<i>34th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/13/2025</i>
<i>Michael P. Kushmerek</i>	<i>3rd Worcester</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>James Arciero</i>	<i>2nd Middlesex</i>	<i>2/21/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>
<i>Jennifer Balinsky Armini</i>	<i>8th Essex</i>	<i>3/4/2025</i>
<i>Simon Cataldo</i>	<i>14th Middlesex</i>	<i>9/5/2025</i>
<i>Rob Consalvo</i>	<i>14th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/20/2025</i>
<i>Manny Cruz</i>	<i>7th Essex</i>	<i>2/4/2025</i>
<i>Marjorie C. Decker</i>	<i>25th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/31/2025</i>
<i>Michelle M. DuBois</i>	<i>10th Plymouth</i>	<i>5/15/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>3/18/2025</i>
<i>Paul R. Feeney</i>	<i>Bristol and Norfolk</i>	<i>2/13/2025</i>
<i>Sean Garballey</i>	<i>23rd Middlesex</i>	<i>5/22/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>3/16/2025</i>
<i>Russell E. Holmes</i>	<i>6th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/18/2025</i>
<i>Kevin G. Honan</i>	<i>17th Suffolk</i>	<i>5/16/2025</i>
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>7/18/2025</i>

<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>1/31/2025</i>
<i>Mary S. Keefe</i>	<i>15th Worcester</i>	<i>3/4/2025</i>
<i>David Henry Argosky LeBoeuf</i>	<i>17th Worcester</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Adrian C. Madaro</i>	<i>1st Suffolk</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/3/2025</i>
<i>John Francis Moran</i>	<i>9th Suffolk</i>	<i>9/9/2025</i>
<i>Tram T. Nguyen</i>	<i>18th Essex</i>	<i>2/14/2025</i>
<i>Steven Owens</i>	<i>29th Middlesex</i>	<i>2/6/2025</i>
<i>Edward R. Philips</i>	<i>8th Norfolk</i>	<i>2/13/2025</i>
<i>Sean Reid</i>	<i>11th Essex</i>	<i>3/18/2025</i>
<i>Estela A. Reyes</i>	<i>4th Essex</i>	<i>2/3/2025</i>
<i>Margaret R. Scarsdale</i>	<i>1st Middlesex</i>	<i>3/3/2025</i>
<i>Danillo A. Sena</i>	<i>37th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/31/2025</i>
<i>Dawne Shand</i>	<i>1st Essex</i>	<i>2/24/2025</i>
<i>Thomas M. Stanley</i>	<i>9th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/22/2025</i>
<i>Chynah Tyler</i>	<i>7th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/13/2025</i>
<i>Steven Ultrino</i>	<i>33rd Middlesex</i>	<i>3/12/2025</i>
<i>Erika Uyterhoeven</i>	<i>27th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/20/2025</i>
<i>Marcus S. Vaughn</i>	<i>9th Norfolk</i>	<i>5/20/2025</i>
<i>Thomas P. Walsh</i>	<i>12th Essex</i>	<i>3/17/2025</i>
<i>Christopher J. Worrell</i>	<i>5th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 1423

By Representatives Barber of Somerville and Kushmerek of Fitchburg, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1423) of Christine P. Barber, Michael P. Kushmerek and others that the Department of Education create and administer a field placement grant program to ensure a stable, diverse workforce of licensed social workers. Higher Education.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 1253 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to social work uplifting practices and exam removal.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. The first paragraph of section 131 of chapter 112 of the General Laws is
2 hereby amended by striking out the words “has passed an examination prepared by the board for
3 this purpose;”.

4 SECTION 2. The first sentence of the first paragraph of section 132 of chapter 112 of the
5 General Laws is hereby amended by striking out the words “Examinations for licensed certified
6 social workers, including those in independent clinical practice” and inserting in place thereof
7 the following words:- Examinations for licensed independent clinical social workers.

8 SECTION 3. Chapter 112 of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after
9 section 135C the following section:-

Section 135D. To ensure a stable, diverse workforce of licensed social workers in the commonwealth, and to provide for increased support and retention of practicing licensed social workers, the commonwealth shall administer a paid practicum placement grant program for Master of Social Work (MSW) students in good standing. The program shall, subject to appropriation, provide grant funding to designated recipients with a specific focus on recruiting and retaining MSW students from historically marginalized communities and low-income communities. Funds to establish this program shall be allocated from state, federal, or other dedicated resources, including existing trust funds.

Eligible applicants must attend a school of social work Masters program physically located in Massachusetts that has been accredited by the Council on Social Work Education.

Applicant data, including application details submitted, shall be tracked by the executive office so that the program efficacy and equity can be evaluated.

SECTION 4. Section 136 of chapter 112 of the General Laws is hereby amended by inserting after the fourth paragraph the following paragraph:-

Licensed independent clinical social workers engaged in independent clinical practice who provide one-on-one supervision to a licensed certified social worker, licensed social worker, Masters of social work intern, or Bachelors of social work intern, shall be eligible to receive up to 8 continuing education credits during a licensing period for this supervision.

SECTION 5. The executive office of health and human services shall conduct an evaluation of the impact of removal of the licensing examination requirement for Licensed Certified Social Workers under sections 1 and 2, should it deem such an evaluation necessary. The evaluation may include an analysis of the impact of removing the examination requirement

on alleviating shortages of qualified social workers, expanding access to quality behavioral health services, increasing the diversity of the social worker workforce among diverse language skills, race, ethnicity, and cultural backgrounds, and the impact of any increase in diversity on patient care, particularly for vulnerable populations. In preparing the evaluation, the consultant shall meet with representatives of organizations representing social workers, social work education, social work testing, social work patients, behavioral health advocacy organizations, and other groups that may assist the evaluation. The evaluation and analysis shall be conducted independently of the executive office. The executive office shall submit the evaluation to the committee on higher education, the committee on mental health, substance use and recovery and the house and senate committees on ways and means no later than the year in which said evaluation was initiated.